

Various entry-level positions in PCB industry post training

- Circuit design engineer for product/services organisations
- PCB CAD design engineer for product/services organisations
- Test engineer
- Process engineer in electronic manufacturing companies
- Supply-chain management roles
- Field application/customer support engineer

sis and quality control initially. It will be a good learning curve for them to verify their seniors' designs." He adds, "Once they are design-ready, they would later be assigned to design small circuit boards and customer PCBs."

Remuneration

Printed circuit boards are fundamental components of all electronics and the field is well entrenched in India, which is one of the top global manufacturers of PCBs today. Vivek Madhukar, COO, TimesJobs.com explains, "While starting salaries for freshers may be low, much like good programmers are in high demand, good PCB designers can also command salaries upward of 1.5 million (15 lakhs). Most careers for these skills are in the manufacturing, IT and engineering sectors." Talking about locations for jobs, he says, "The golden triangle of Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Chennai account for a majority of jobs in the field, so freshers should be open to relocate."

Kulkarni informs that a fresher's pay package is typically 150,000 rupees per annum. At Argus Technologies, Kumar shares, "A fresh graduate would be offered a starting salary of 216,000 per annum whereas an experienced professional with two to three years of experience would get 360,000 per annum." "We do hire fresh candidates from engineering colleges and have no preference to IITs/NITs as such. Selection is based on a written test and personal interview. In the written test, our focus is mainly on basic electronics, mathematics and problem-solving skills."

At another PCB designing firm SIENNA ECAD Technologies Pvt Ltd, Savita R. Ganjigatti, VP engineering - PWB Design informs, "Yes, we recruit

freshers and offer them training for a year. During the training period, a stipend of 10,000 per month is provided and, on confirmation after a year, they are offered a minimum of 200,000 per annum." "We recruit from other engineering institutions and focus on skill-oriented candidates rather than the institute. But for signal/power integrity and EMI analysis, we recruit masters degree holders particularly," complements Satish.

Going by the statistics provided by TimesJobs.com, a massive 44% of the jobs in the PCB industry are in the salary range of 100,000 to 250,000 rupees per annum. Around 28% jobs for junior-level professionals pay anywhere from 250,000 to 500,000 rupees per annum, while 18% jobs for mid-level pay between 500,000 and 1,000,000 rupees.

Demand areas

According to TimesJobs.com, the manufacturing and engineering industry tops the list of industries hiring engineers to work in the PCB design domain with about 34% share of jobs, followed by the IT industry with a share of 26%. IT-hardware/semiconductor and networking industries offer 14% of the jobs.

Apart from Bengaluru with 27%, the list of top locations for jobs in PCB design field indicates Hyderabad, Chennai and Mumbai sharing 12%, 10% and 9% of the pie, respectively. Remaining jobs are scattered in other locations.

Skills required

Printed circuit board designers utilise computer-aided design (CAD) tools to create circuits that are accommodated on these boards. They must also be able to specify how the connections

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